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(54) CUTTING BOARD ASSEMBLY

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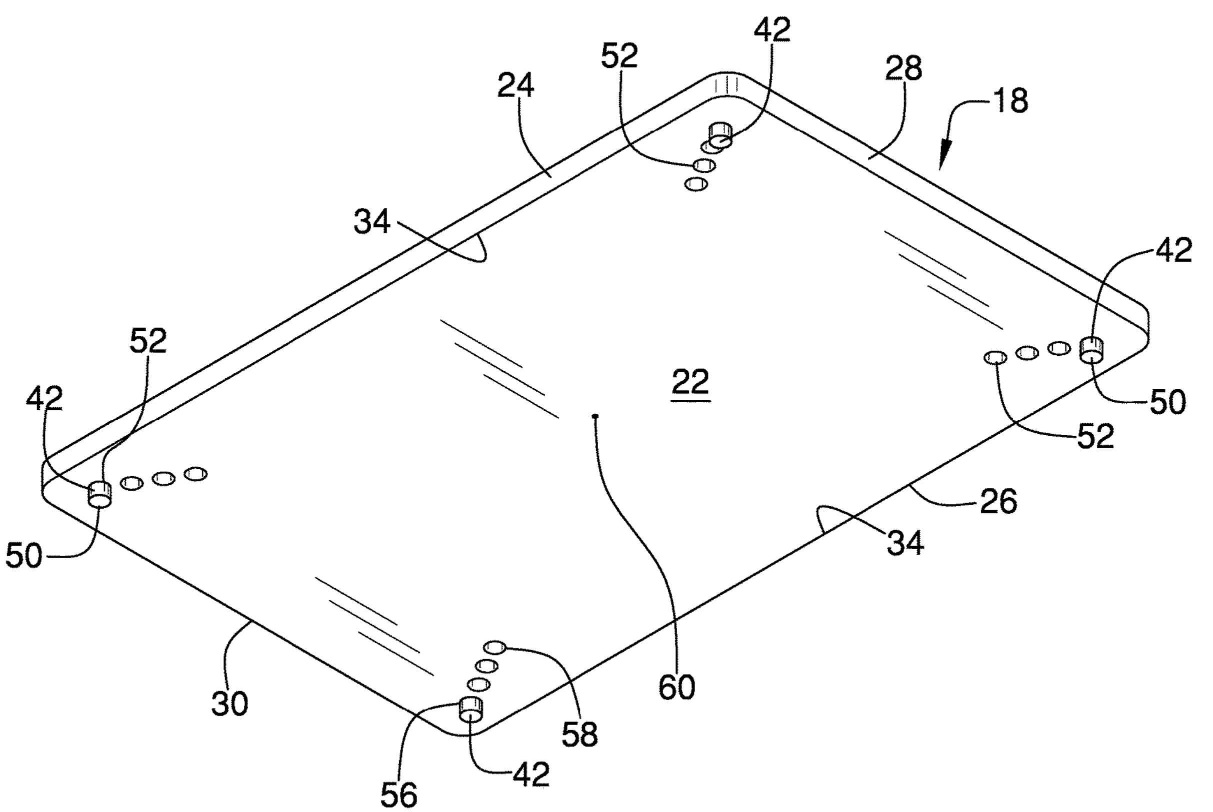
(57) **ABSTRACT**

A cutting board assembly that is slidably mountable to a countertop while extending over a sink opening includes a panel upon which to position food for cutting. The panel has top and bottom sides, first and second lateral edges, and front and rear edges. A distance from the front to the rear edge is greater than a space from a front side to a back side of the sink opening. The panel is positionable on the upper surface so that the panel extends over the sink opening and is supported by the countertop. A plurality of stops is selectively movable and positioned on the bottom side. The stops extends downwardly from the bottom side and into the sink opening when the panel is positioned on the countertop. The stops are abuttable against a perimeter edge of the sink opening to restrict movement of the panel relative to the sink opening.



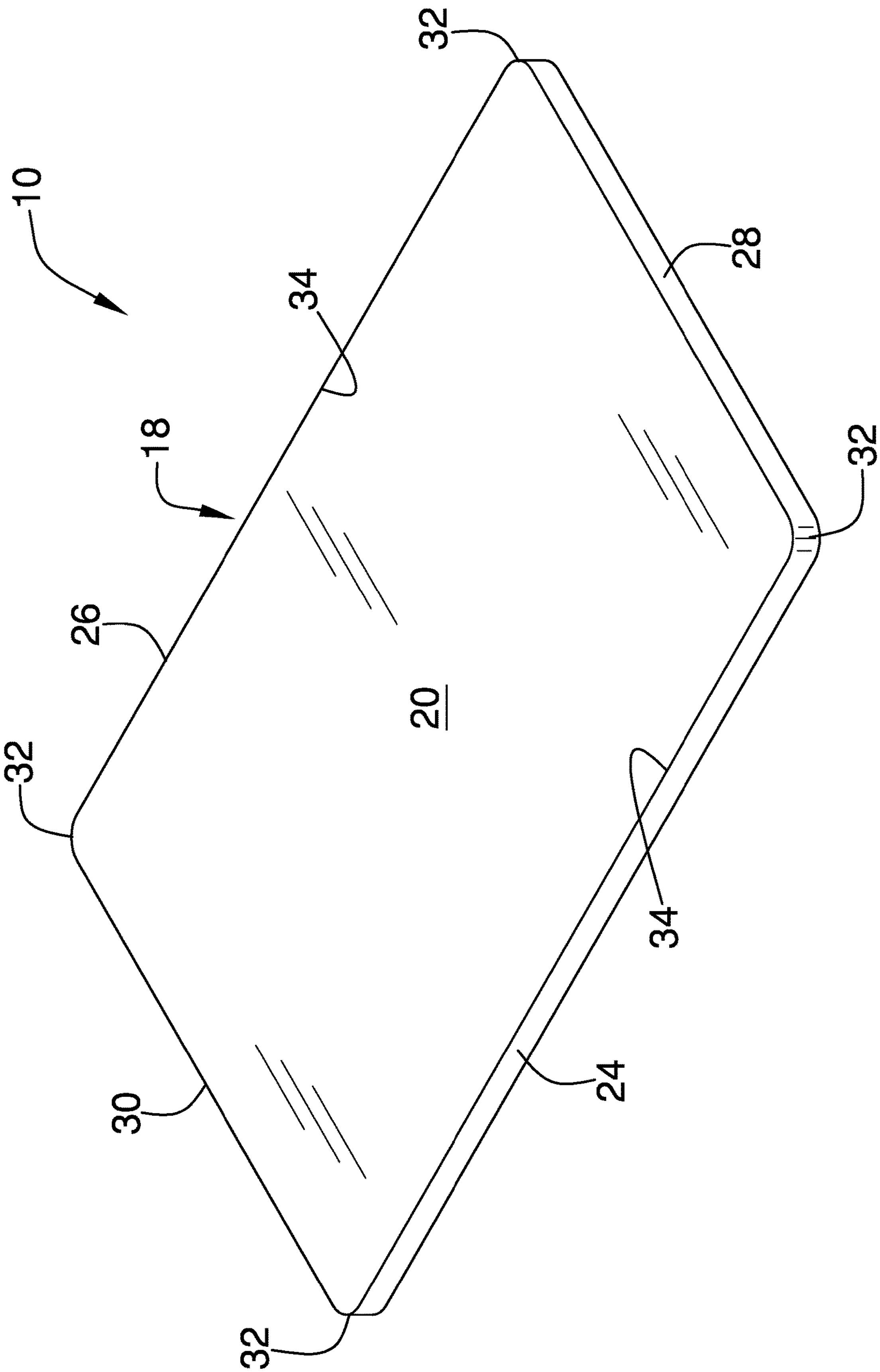


FIG. 1

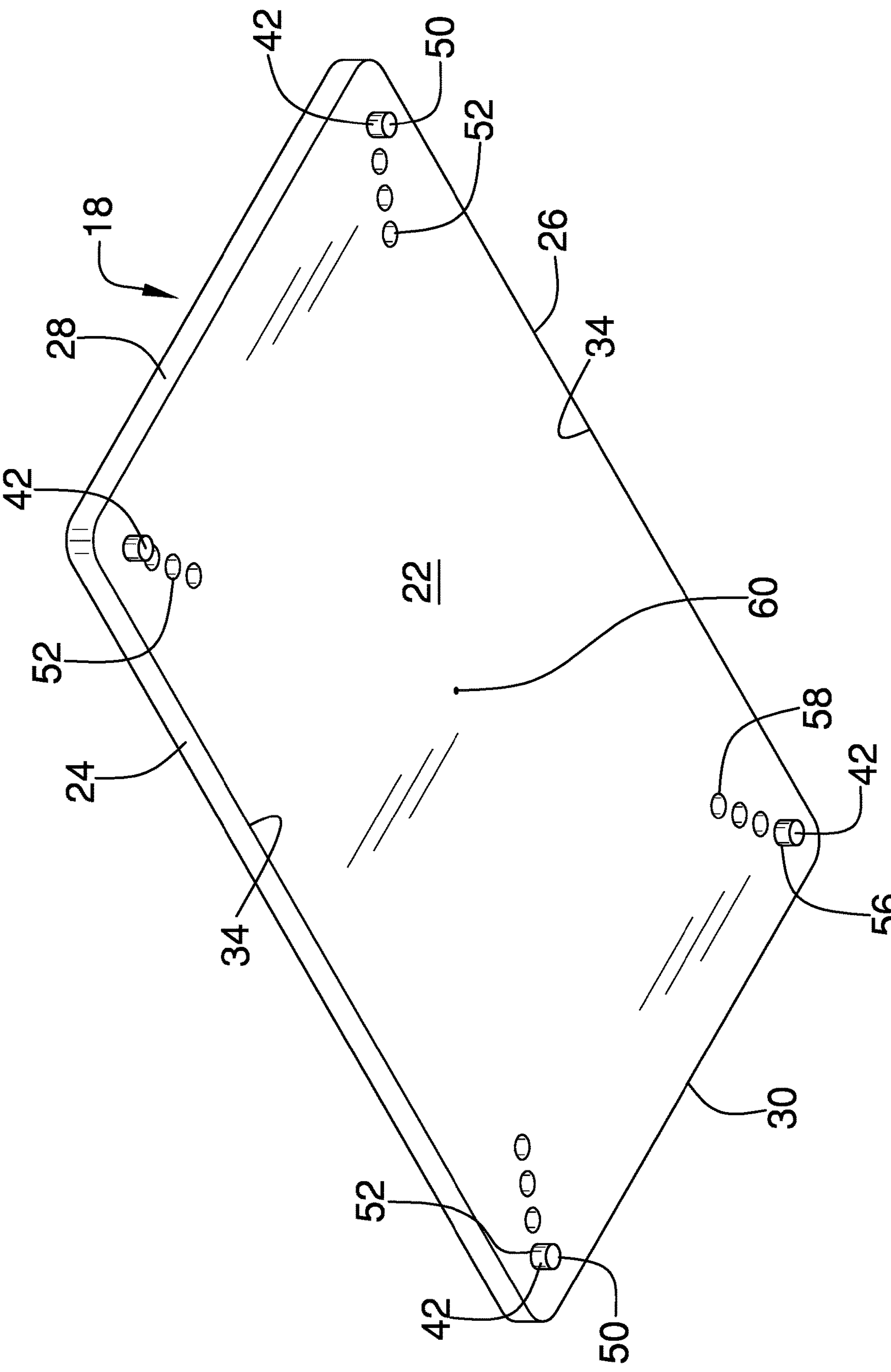


FIG. 2

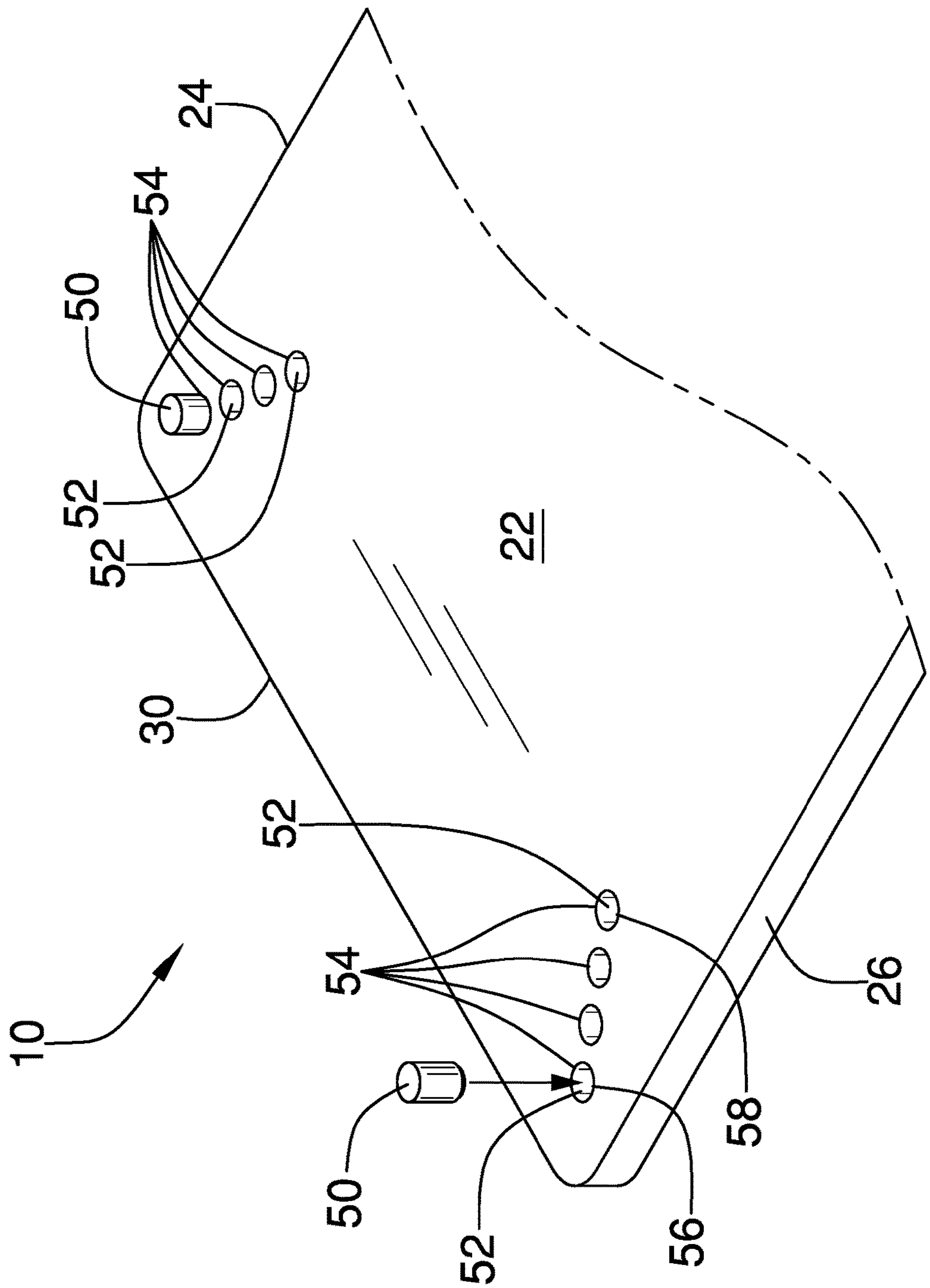


FIG. 3

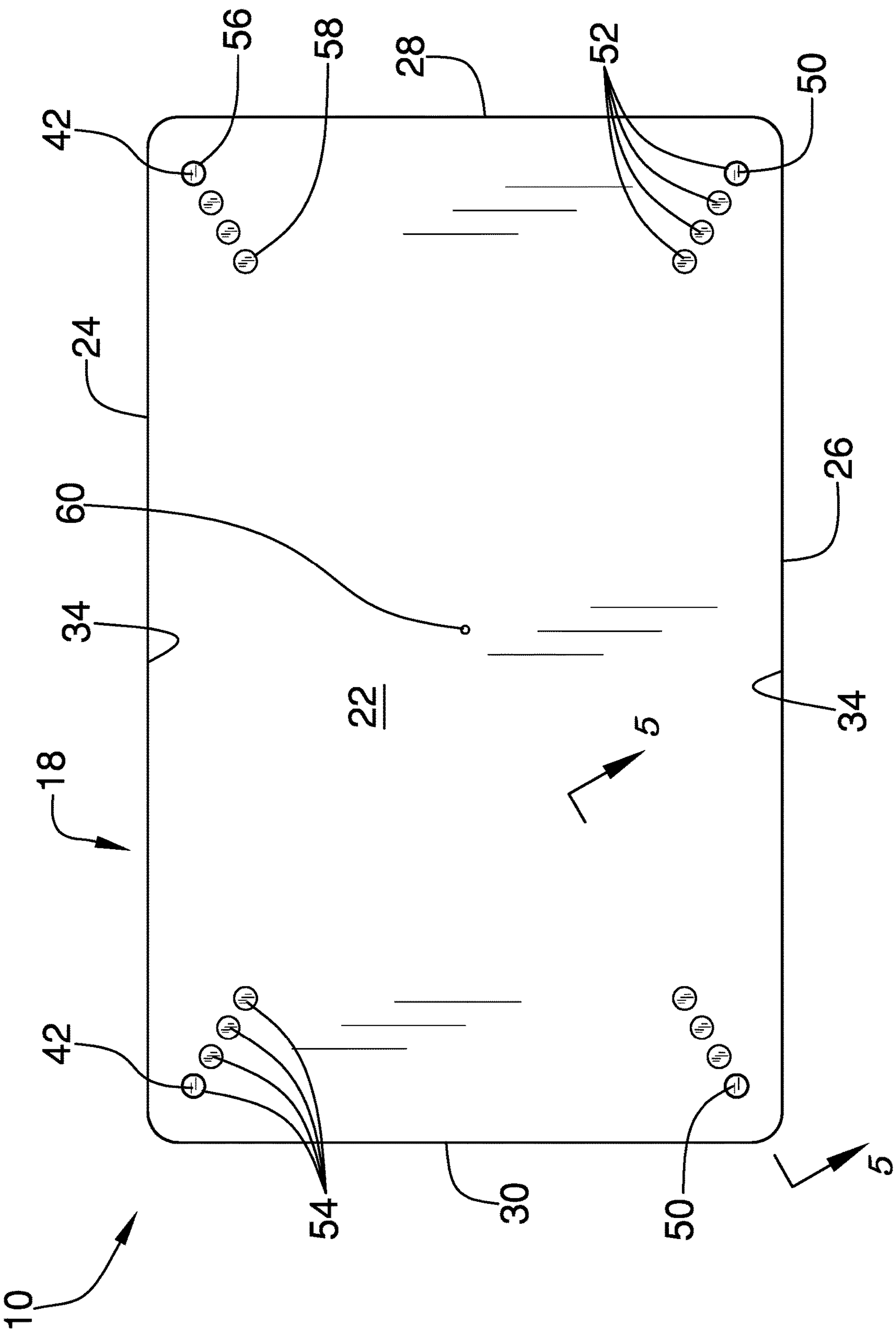


FIG. 4

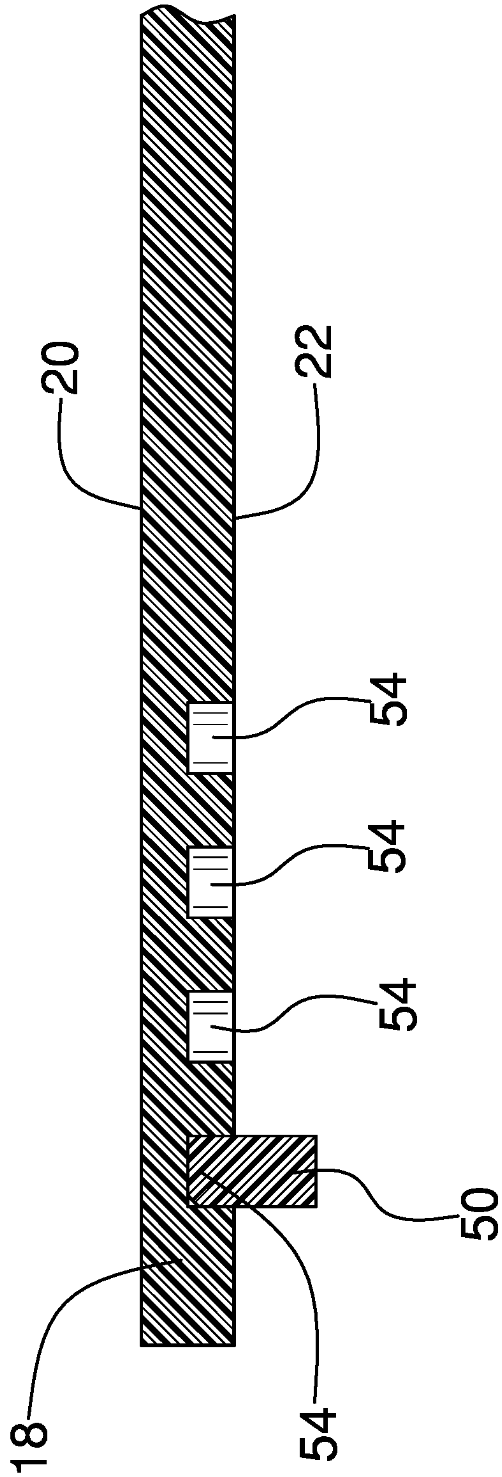


FIG. 5

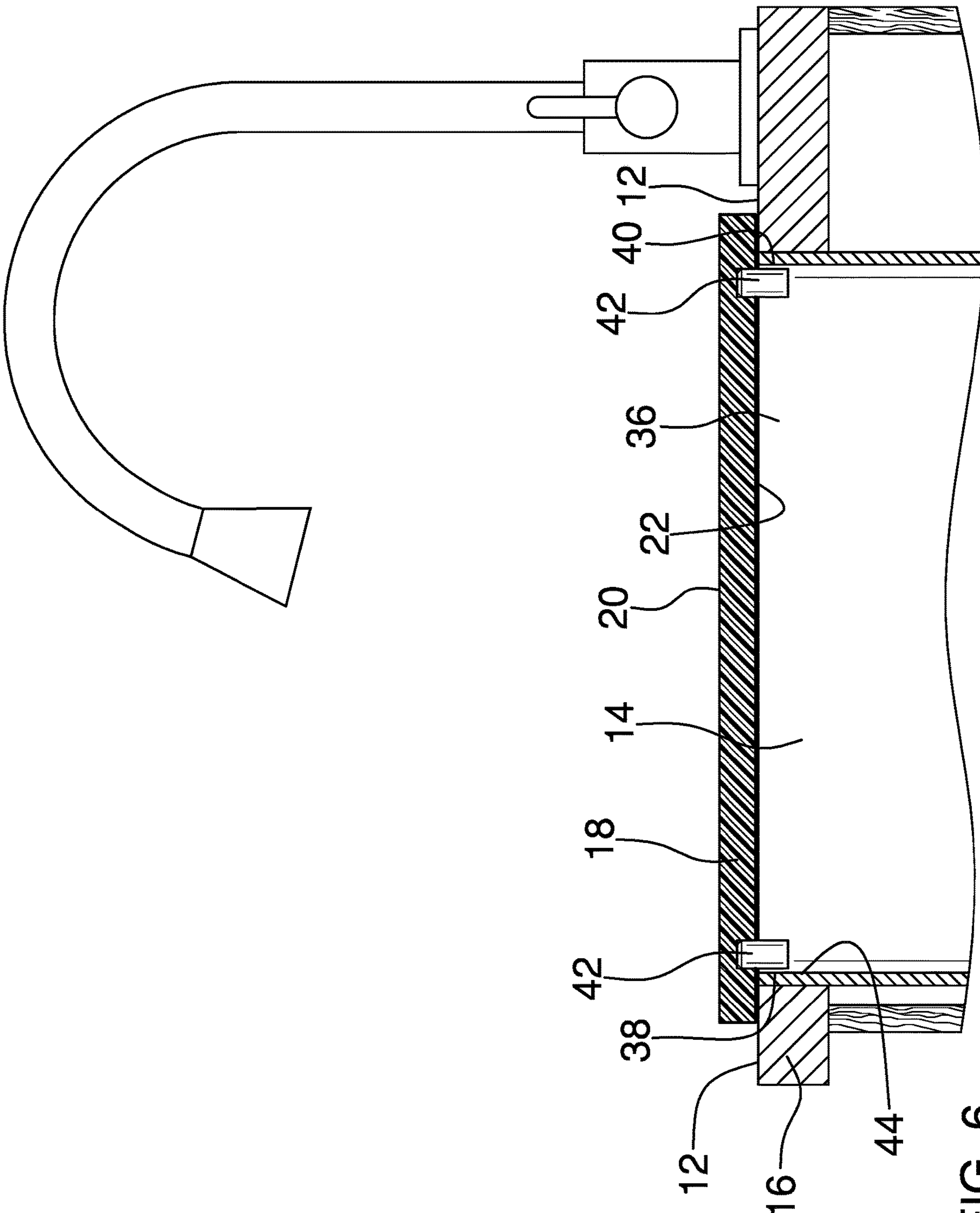


FIG. 6

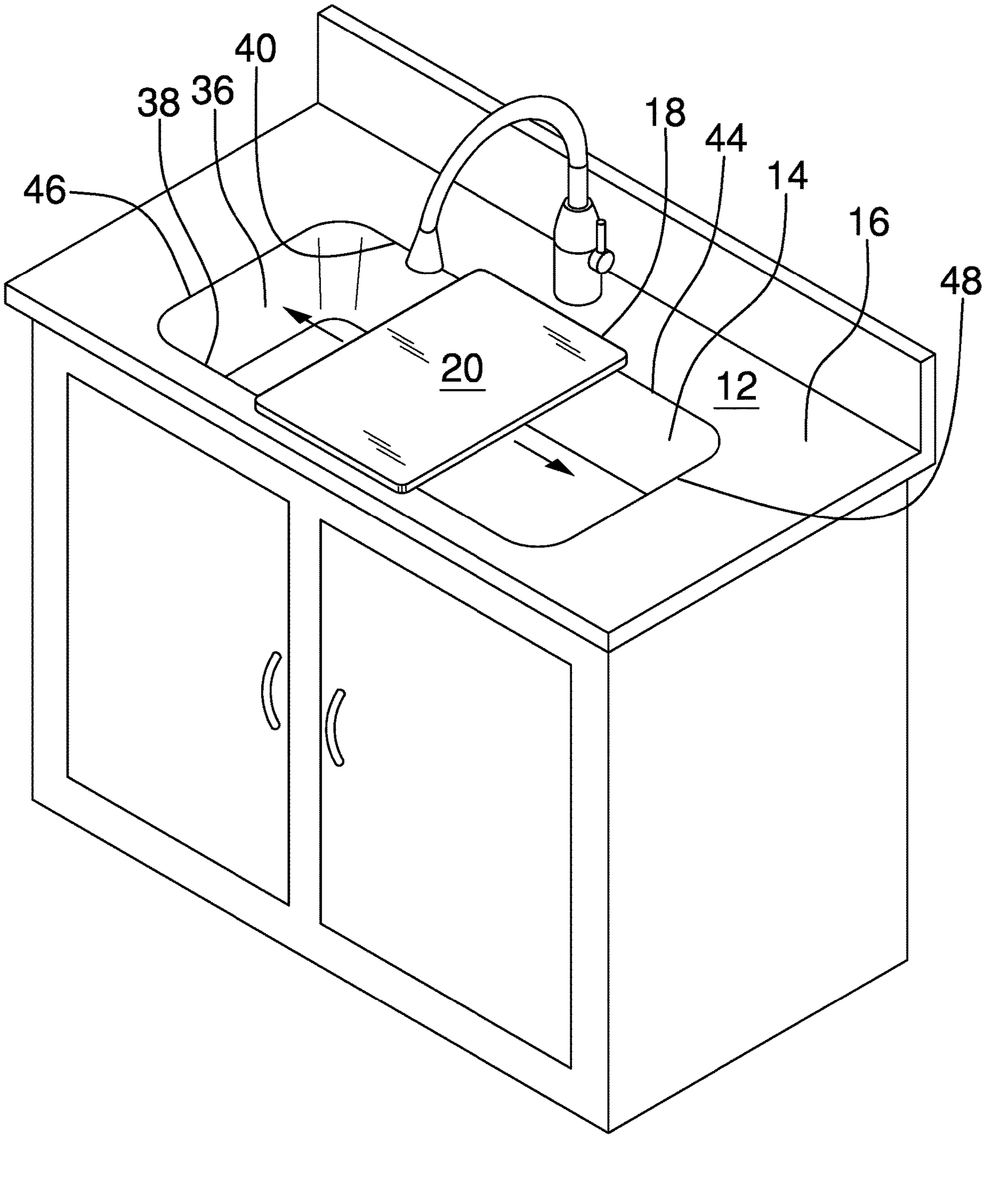


FIG. 7

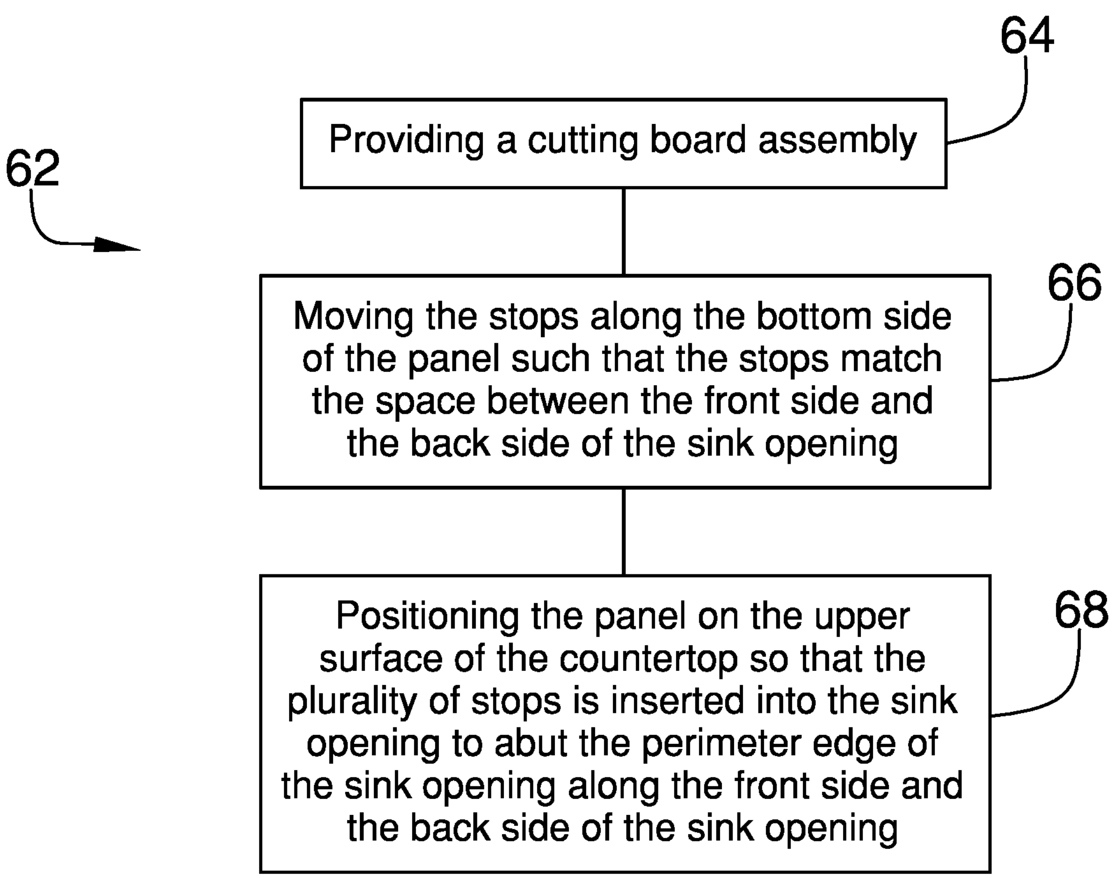

64
62
Providing a cutting board assembly
66
Moving the stops along the bottom side of the panel such that the stops match the space between the front side and the back side of the sink opening
68
Positioning the panel on the upper surface of the countertop so that the plurality of stops is inserted into the sink opening to abut the perimeter edge of the sink opening along the front side and the back side of the sink opening

FIG. 8

CUTTING BOARD ASSEMBLY

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] Not Applicable

STATEMENT REGARDING FEDERALLY SPONSORED RESEARCH OR DEVELOPMENT

[0002] Not Applicable

THE NAMES OF THE PARTIES TO A JOINT RESEARCH AGREEMENT

[0003] Not Applicable

INCORPORATION-BY-REFERENCE OF MATERIAL SUBMITTED ON A COMPACT DISC OR AS A TEXT FILE VIA THE OFFICE ELECTRONIC FILING SYSTEM

[0004] Not Applicable

STATEMENT REGARDING PRIOR DISCLOSURES BY THE INVENTOR OR JOINT INVENTOR

[0005] Not Applicable

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(1) Field of the Invention

[0006] The disclosure relates to cutting boards and more particularly pertains to a new cutting board that is slidably mountable to a countertop. The prior art includes countertop positionable cutting boards which are not slidably mountable to a countertop while extending over a sink opening and which tend to slip and fall into a sink opening if they are positioned thereover.

(2) Description of Related Art including information disclosed under 37 CFR 1.97 and 1.98

[0007] The prior art relates to cutting boards but which do not include movable stops on their bottom sides allowing the cutting boards to be slidably mountable to a countertop while extending over a sink opening.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0008] An embodiment of the disclosure meets the needs presented above by generally comprising a cutting board assembly to position on an upper surface of countertop so that the cutting board assembly extends over a sink opening positioned in the countertop. The cutting board assembly comprises a panel upon which to position food for cutting. The panel has a top side, a bottom side, a first lateral edge, a second lateral edge, a front edge, and a rear edge. A distance from the front edge to the rear edge is greater than a space from a front side to a back side of the sink opening. The panel is positionable on the upper surface so that the panel extends over the sink opening and is supported by the countertop. The stops of a plurality of stops are selectively movable and positioned on the bottom side. The plurality of stops extends downwardly from the bottom side and into the sink opening when the panel is positioned on the countertop. The stops are abuttable against a perimeter edge of the sink opening to restrict movement of the panel relative to the sink opening.

[0009] Another embodiment of the disclosure includes a method of slidably mounting a panel to a countertop with the panel extending over a sink opening. Steps of the method comprise a providing a cutting board assembly, according to the disclosure above, moving the stops along the bottom side of the panel so that the stops match the space between the front side and the back side of the sink opening, and positioning the panel on the upper surface of the countertop so that the stops are inserted into the sink opening to abut the perimeter edge of the sink opening along the front side and the back side of the sink opening.

[0010] There has thus been outlined, rather broadly, the more important features of the disclosure in order that the detailed description thereof that follows may be better understood, and in order that the present contribution to the art may be better appreciated. There are additional features of the disclosure that will be described hereinafter and which will form the subject matter of the claims appended hereto.

[0011] The objects of the disclosure, along with the various features of novelty which characterize the disclosure, are pointed out with particularity in the claims annexed to and forming a part of this disclosure.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWING(S)

[0012] The disclosure will be better understood and objects other than those set forth above will become apparent when consideration is given to the following detailed description thereof. Such description makes reference to the annexed drawings wherein:

[0013] FIG. **1** is a top isometric perspective view of a cutting board assembly according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0014] FIG. **2** is a bottom isometric perspective view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0015] FIG. **3** is a detail view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0016] FIG. **4** is a bottom view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0017] FIG. **5** is a cross-sectional view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0018] FIG. **6** is an in-use view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0019] FIG. **7** is an in-use view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0020] FIG. **8** is a flow diagram of a method utilizing an embodiment of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0021] With reference now to the drawings, and in particular to FIGS. **1** through **8** thereof, a new cutting board embodying the principles and concepts of an embodiment of the disclosure and generally designated by the reference numeral **10** will be described.

[0022] As best illustrated in FIGS. **1** through **8**, the cutting board assembly **10** to position on an upper surface **12** of a countertop **14** so that the cutting board assembly **10** extends over a sink opening **16** positioned in the countertop **14** generally comprises a panel **18** upon which to position food for cutting. The panel **18** has a top side **20**, a bottom side **22**, a first lateral edge **24**, a second lateral edge **26**, a front edge **28**, and a rear edge **30**. The panel **18** is substantially ridged and comprises one or more of wood, plastic, stone, metal, bamboo, cork, or any conventional material used for a cutting board. The panel **18** typically is substantially rectangular but also may be alternatively shaped, such as, but not limited to, circular, oval, or the like. As is shown in the figures, the panel **18** of one embodiment is rectangular and corners **32** of the panel **18** are rounded. A distance **34** from the front edge **28** to the rear edge **30** of the panel **18** is greater than a space **36** from a front side **38** to a back side **40** of the sink opening **16**. The panel **18** thus is positionable on the upper surface **12** so that the panel **18** extends over the sink opening **16** and is supported by the countertop **14**.

[0023] The stops **42** of a plurality of stops **42** are selectively movable and positioned on the bottom side **22**. The plurality of stops **42** extends downwardly from the bottom side **22** and into the sink opening **16** when the panel **18** is positioned on the countertop **14**. The stops **42** are abuttable against a perimeter edge **44** of the sink opening **16** to restrict movement of the panel **18** relative to the sink opening **16**. Typically, the plurality of stops **42** would allow the panel **18** to be selectively slid between a left side **46** and a right side **48** of the sink opening **16**, as is shown in FIG. **7**. The panel **18** extends over the perimeter edge **44** of the sink opening **16** at the front side **38** and the back side **40** of the sink opening **16**. It also is anticipated that the panel **18** could be sized to extend over the perimeter edge **44** of the sink opening **16** at the left side **46** and the right side **48** of the sink opening **16** and thus be slidable between the front side **38** and the back side **40** of the sink opening **16**. Additionally anticipated is a configuration wherein stops **42** engage the perimeter edge **44** along each of the front side **38**, the back side **40**, the left side **46**, and the right side **48** of the sink opening **16** so that the panel **18** covers and is substantially fixed relative to the sink opening **16**.

[0024] An additional benefit of the cutting board assembly **10** is that one can use it on the countertop **14** and then can easily lift the panel **18** as the stops **42** elevate the panel **18** above the countertop **14**. Prior art cutting boards often require sliding over an edge of the countertop **14** before they can be lifted.

[0025] Each stop **42** may comprise a peg **50**, as is shown in FIGS. **2-6**. The peg **50** is selectively positionable on and attachable to the bottom side **22** of the panel **18**. The present invention also anticipates the plurality of stops **42** comprising other stopping means, such as, but not limited to, extensible slats, protruding magnets, or the like.

[0026] The peg **50** may be selectively insertable into a respective recess **52** of a plurality of recesses **52** that extends into the bottom side **22**. Each recess **52** has a respective spacing either of the front edge **28** or the rear edge **30**. The peg **50** may be cylindrical, cuboid, elliptic cylinder, or the like. The peg **50** may be friction fit into the respective recess **52** to attach the peg **50** to the panel **18**, although the present invention also anticipates other methods to reversibly attaching the pegs **50** to the panel **18**, such as, but not limited to threading, twist locks, magnets, keyhole slots, suction cups, hook and loop fasteners, or the like.

[0027] As is shown in FIG. **4**, the plurality of stops **42** may comprise four stops **42** and the plurality of recesses **52** therefore comprises four sets of wells **54**. Each set of wells **54** comprises at least three wells **54**. Each set of wells **54** extends from proximate to one of the front edge **28** and the rear edge **30** toward the other of the front edge **28** and the rear edge **30** along one of the first lateral edge **24** and the second lateral edge **26**.

[0028] The recesses **52** of each set of wells **54** may be aligned linearly so that an outermost well **56** of the set of wells **54** is closest to the one of the front edge **28** and the rear edge **30** and an innermost well **58** of the set of wells **54** is furthest from the one of the front edge **28** and the rear edge **30**. The outermost well **56** of the set of wells **54** may be closest to one of the first lateral edge **24** and the second lateral edge **26** and the innermost well **58** of the set of wells **54** may be furthest from the one of the first lateral edge **24** and the second lateral edge **26**. As such, each set of wells **54** extends from proximate to a respective corner **32** of the panel **18** generally toward a center **60** of the panel **18**. This configuration allows for finer adjustment of the position of the stops **42**, relative to sets of wells **54** that extend in parallel with the first lateral edge **24** and the second lateral edge **26**, thereby enabling a tighter fit of the cutting board assembly **10** to the perimeter edge **44** of the sink opening **16**.

[0029] In use, the cutting board assembly **10** enables a method **62** of slidably mounting a panel **18** to a countertop **14** with the panel **18** extending over a sink opening **16**. The method **62** comprises a first step **64** of providing a cutting board assembly **10**, according to the specification above. A second step **66** of the method **62** is moving the stops **42** along the bottom side **22** of the panel **18** so that the stops **42** match the space **36** between the front side **38** and the back side **40** of the sink opening **16**. A third step **68** of the method **62** is positioning the panel **18** on the upper surface **12** of the countertop **14** so that the plurality of stops **42** is inserted into the sink opening **16** to abut the perimeter edge **44** of the sink opening **16** along the front side **38** and the back side **40** of the sink opening **16**.

[0030] With respect to the above description then, it is to be realized that the optimum dimensional relationships for the parts of an embodiment enabled by the disclosure, to include variations in size, materials, shape, form, function and manner of operation, assembly and use, are deemed readily apparent and obvious to one skilled in the art, and all equivalent relationships to those illustrated in the drawings and described in the specification are intended to be encompassed by an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0031] Therefore, the foregoing is considered as illustrative only of the principles of the disclosure. Further, since numerous modifications and changes will readily occur to those skilled in the art, it is not desired to limit the disclosure to the exact construction and operation shown and described, and accordingly, all suitable modifications and equivalents may be resorted to, falling within the scope of the disclosure. In this patent document, the word "comprising" is used in its non-limiting sense to mean that items following the word are included, but items not specifically mentioned are not excluded. A reference to an element by the indefinite article "a" does not exclude the possibility that more than one of the element is present, unless the context clearly requires that there be only one of the elements.

I claim:

1. A cutting board assembly for positioning on an upper surface of countertop such that the cutting board assembly extends over a sink opening positioned in the countertop, the cutting board assembly comprising:

a panel for positioning food upon such that the food may be cut, the panel having a top side, a bottom side, a first lateral edge, a second lateral edge, a front edge, and a rear edge, a distance from the front edge to the rear edge being greater than a space from a front side to a back side of the sink opening, wherein the panel is positionable on the upper surface such that the panel extends over the sink opening and is supported by the countertop; and

a plurality of stops being selectively movable and positioned on the bottom side, the plurality of stops extending downwardly from the bottom side and into the sink opening when the panel is positioned on the countertop, the plurality of stops being abuttable against a perimeter edge of the sink opening to restrict movement of the panel relative to the sink opening.

2. The cutting board assembly of claim **1**, wherein each stop comprises a peg, the peg being selectively positionable on and attachable to the bottom side of the panel.

3. The cutting board assembly of claim **2**, wherein the peg is selectively insertable into a respective recess of a plurality of recesses extending into the bottom side, each recess having a respective spacing either of the front edge and the rear edge.

4. The cutting board assembly of claim **3**, wherein:

the plurality of stops comprises four stops; and

the plurality of recesses comprising four sets of wells, each set of wells extending from proximate to one of the front edge and the rear edge toward the other of the front edge and the rear edge along one of the first lateral edge and the second lateral edge.

5. The cutting board assembly of claim **4**, wherein each set of wells is linear such that an outermost well of the set of wells is closest to the one of the front edge and the rear edge and an innermost well of the set of wells is furthest from the one of the front edge and the rear edge.

6. The cutting board assembly of claim **5**, wherein the outermost well of the set of wells is closest to the respective one of the first lateral edge and the second lateral edge and the innermost well of the set of wells is furthest from the respective one of the first lateral edge and the second lateral edge.

7. The cutting board assembly of claim **3**, wherein the peg is cylindrical.

8. The cutting board assembly of claim **3**, wherein the peg is friction fit into the respective recess for attaching the peg to the panel.

9. The cutting board assembly of claim **4**, wherein each set of wells comprises at least three wells.

10. The cutting board assembly of claim **1**, wherein the panel comprises one or more of wood, plastic, stone, metal, bamboo, or cork.

11. The cutting board assembly of claim **1**, wherein the panel is substantially rectangular.

12. A method of slidably mounting a panel to a countertop with the panel extending over a sink opening, the method comprising the steps of:

providing a cutting board assembly for positioning on an upper surface of countertop such that the cutting board assembly extends over a sink opening positioned in the countertop, the cutting board assembly comprising:

a panel for positioning food upon such that the food may be cut, the panel having a top side, a bottom side, a first lateral edge, a second lateral edge, a front edge, and a rear edge, a distance from the front edge to the rear edge being greater than a space from a front side to a back side of the sink opening, wherein the panel is positionable on the upper surface such that the panel extends over the sink opening and is supported by the countertop; and

a plurality of stops being selectively movable and positioned on the bottom side, the plurality of stops extending downwardly from the bottom side and into the sink opening when the panel is positioned on the countertop, the plurality of stops being abuttable against a perimeter edge of the sink opening to restrict movement of the panel relative to the sink opening;

moving the stops along the bottom side of the panel such that the stops match the space between the front side and the back side of the sink opening; and

positioning the panel on the upper surface of the countertop such that the plurality of stops is inserted into the sink opening to abut the perimeter edge of the sink opening along the front side and the back side of the sink opening.

13. The method of claim **12**, wherein each stop comprises a peg, the peg being selectively positionable on and attachable to the bottom side of the panel.

14. The method of claim **13**, wherein the peg is selectively insertable into a respective recess of a plurality of recesses extending into the bottom side, each recess having a respective spacing from either the front edge or the rear edge.

15. The method of claim **14**, wherein:

the plurality of stops comprises four stops; and

the plurality of recesses comprising four sets of wells, each set of wells extending from proximate to one of the front edge and the rear edge toward the other of the front edge and the rear edge along one of the first lateral edge and the second lateral edge.

16. The method of claim **15**, wherein each set of wells is linear such that an outermost well of the set of wells is closest to the one of the front edge and the rear edge and an innermost well of the set of wells is furthest from the one of the front edge and the rear edge.

17. The method of claim **16**, wherein the outermost well of the set of wells is closest to one of the first lateral edge and the second lateral edge and the innermost well of the set of wells is furthest from the one of the first lateral edge and the second lateral edge.

18. The method of claim **14**, wherein the peg is cylindrical.

19. The method of claim **14**, wherein the peg is friction fit into the respective recess for attaching the peg to the panel.

20. The cutting board assembly of claim **15**, wherein each set of wells comprises at least three wells.

* * * * *